

Mary: God's Surprising Plan

MEMORY VERSE

Remember that I commanded you to be strong and brave. So don't be afraid.
The Lord your God will be with you.

Joshua 1:9

THE BIG IDEA

God's plans can be surprising, and He gives us everything we need to say yes. When the angel came to Mary with the biggest surprise ever, she didn't understand it all – but she trusted God and obeyed Him anyway.

WHAT WE DID TODAY

- Opened a surprise box and talked about times someone has asked us to do something surprising or a bit scary
- Watched the story of Mary from the Bible and how she trusted God's surprising plan
- Played a True or False game to remember the story
- Made a 3D triorama craft of the angel bringing Mary God's surprising message

JESUS CONNECTION

Mary was brave, and she trusted God even when His plan was surprising. But Mary needed rescuing too. That's why, when the angel came, she praised God and called Him "my Saviour" - Mary knew she wasn't perfect on her own. The baby she carried grew up to be the One who would take the punishment for her sin, and ours, by dying on the cross. Mary held the Saviour in her arms as a baby, and we get to trust Him as our Saviour today.

FOLLOW UP AT HOME

TALK ABOUT IT

- Who came to Mary with a surprising message from God?
- How do you think Mary felt when the angel first appeared?
- What did Mary do even though God's plan was surprising and a bit scary?

TRY AT HOME

- Wrap up a little surprise for someone in your family, and talk together about God's biggest surprise – sending Jesus to rescue us
- Practise saying the memory verse out loud together
- Stand the Mary triorama somewhere at home and let your child retell the story